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IT Project Management Support

Lecture 9

Managing Teams (1)

- Stages of Team Development
- Team Dysfunctions



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5 Stage Model of Team Development

Based on:

<https://toggl.com/track/stages-of-team-development/>

<https://project-management.com/stages-of-team-development/>

<https://www.thoughtfulleader.com/5-stages-of-team-development/>

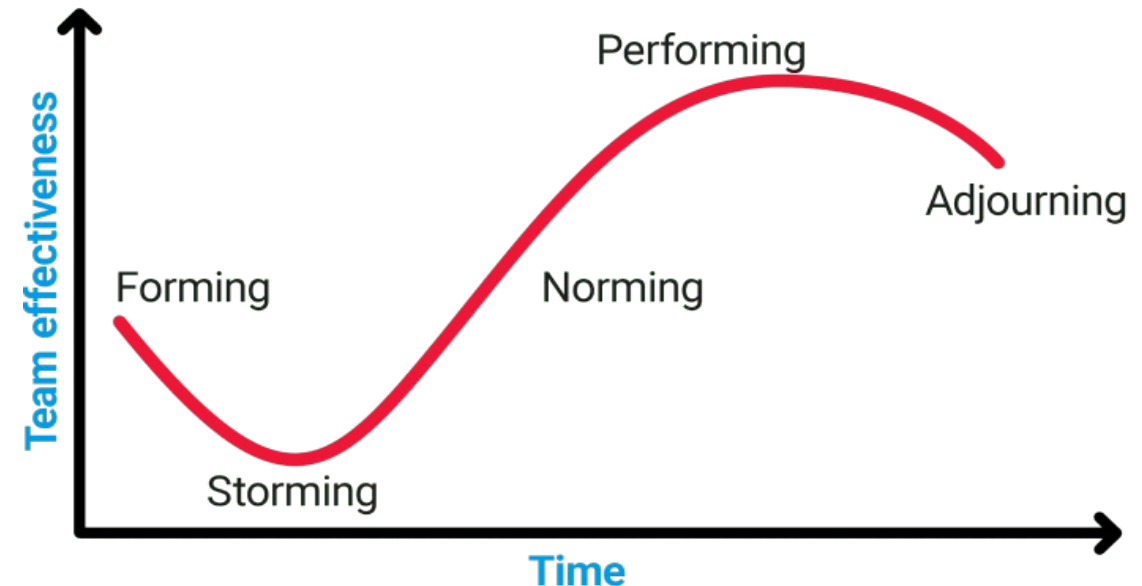
<https://riter.co/blog/models-of-team-effectiveness>

https://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newLDR_86.htm

5 Stage Model of Team Development

- The main goal of team development is to help people work together more effectively to improve project performance.
- Bruce Tuckman's model of team development, worked out in 1965 and modified in the 1970s, remains relevant today.
- He used the model of team development to describe the path that most teams follow on their way to high performance
- The Tuckman model describes five stages of team development:

1. **Forming**
2. **Storming**
3. **Norming**
4. **Performing**
5. **Adjourning**



5 Stage Model of Team Development

1. **Forming** involves the introduction of team members, either at the initiation of the team or as new members are introduced. This stage is necessary, but little work is actually achieved.
2. **Storming** occurs when team members have different opinions for how the team should operate. People test each other, and there is often conflict within the team.
3. **Norming** is achieved when team members have developed a common working method, and cooperation and collaboration replace the conflict and mistrust of the previous phase.
4. **Performing** occurs when the emphasis is on reaching the team's goals rather than working on team process. Relationships are settled, and team members are likely to build loyalty toward each other. At this stage, the team is able to manage tasks that are more complex and cope with greater change.
5. **Adjourning** involves the break-up of the team after it successfully reaches its goals and completes the work.

1. Forming

- Group is initially coming together.
- Period is characterized by shyness, and uncertainty among members.
- The “polite” stage in which the team starts to form.
- Everyone is trying to figure out what the team concept is, what their role is.
 - Why are we here? What are we doing?
 - What is our goal, our purpose?
- Extraverted outspoken members may rapidly assume some kind of leadership role.
- Initial “silent” leaders may take the reins.
- The team is usually positive – for the most part – for the initial meetings.
- No one has offended anyone at this point yet!

1. Forming (cont.)

- Forming includes feelings and behaviors of:
 - Excitement, anticipation, and optimism.
 - Pride in being chosen for the project.
 - A tentative attachment to the team and anxiety about the job.
 - Defining the tasks and how they will be accomplished.
 - Determining acceptable group behavior.
 - Deciding what information needs to be gathered.
 - Abstract discussions of the concepts and issues, and for some members, impatience with these discussions.

2. Storming

- The honeymoon is over.
- The silent leaders may be clashing for control of the group.
- People disagree and may blame the team concept, saying it doesn't work.
- Management needs to do a lot of coaching to get people to work past their differences, may take separate 1-on-1's with people.
- Once established - period of vying for positions and roles within the group.
- Some seek out and compete for status, control, authority and influence.
- Inner conflict. A period of "testing-out" the leaders.
- Disagreements and arguments arise, are fuelled and produced.
- In the end, roles are eventually allocated.
- The initial leaders may not survive this period: it is the most uncomfortable phase of the group's life.

2. Storming (cont.)

- Storming includes feelings and behaviors of:
 - Resisting the tasks mutually agreed upon by the team.
 - Resisting quality improvement approaches suggested by other members.
 - Sharp fluctuations in attitude about the team and the project's chance of success.
 - Arguing among members even when they agree on the real issues.
 - Defensiveness, competition, and choosing sides.
 - Questioning the wisdom of those who selected this project and appointed the other members of the team.
 - Establishing unrealistic goals. Disunity, increased tension, and jealousy.

3. Norming

- The team starting to work well together, and has turned around from the “storming” phase.
- They may start to “brag up” the team concept to others who aren’t in the team and will be very positive about their role/ team group.
- Often, the team will bounce back and forth between “storming” and “norming” when issues crop up.
- Regressions will become fewer and fewer and the team will bounce back to “norming” in a quicker manner as the team “matures.”
- The natural leaders at this stage may not be the ones who were visible in stages 1 & 2. Those people may no longer have the “unofficial lead roles” within the team.
- This team still takes management direction, but not as much as storming.

3. Norming (cont.)

- Norming includes feelings and behaviors of:
 - An ability to express criticism openly and constructively.
 - Acceptance of membership in the team.
 - An attempt to achieve harmony by avoiding conflict.
 - More friendliness, confiding in each other, and sharing of personal problems.
 - A sense of team cohesion, spirit, and goals.
 - Establishing and maintaining team ground rules and boundaries.

4. Performing

- This is the level where the team becomes a high– performance team.
- They can be given new projects and tasks and accomplish them successfully, and very seldom fall back into the “storming” phase.
- At this level, the team is taking on new work on their own, and selling it to other teams.
- At this level, the team can usually take on a new member or two with little trouble as far as regressing goes.
- They are a complete self-managing team and require little, if any, external direction.
- Work and progress starts with a relatively stable group structure.
- Moving in line, towards goals and completion.

4. Performing (cont.)

- Performing includes feelings and behaviors of:
 - Members have insights into personal and group processes, and better understanding of each other's strengths and weakness, and how those contribute to the success of the team's outcomes
 - Constructive self-change with mutual support.
 - Ability to prevent or work through group problems.
 - Close attachment to the team.
- The team is now an effective, cohesive unit.

5. Adjourning

- The team briefs and shares the improved process during this phase.
- When the team finally completes that last briefing, there is always a bittersweet sense of accomplishment coupled with the reluctance to say good-bye.
- Many relationships formed within these teams continue long after the team disbands.
- Completion and disengagement.
- Separation and ending from tasks and members.
- Pride and accomplishment may be felt.
- Some describe stage as "Deforming and Mourning" - recognizing the sense of loss felt by group members.

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Five Stages of Team Development

	FORMING	STORMING	NORMING	PERFORMING	ADJOURNING
GENERAL OBSERVATIONS	Uncertainty about roles, looking outside for guidance.	Growing confidence in team, rejecting outside authority.	Concern about being different, wanting to be a part of the team.	Concern with getting the job done.	Recognition period of member's contributions to the project now completed.
CONTENT ISSUES	Some attempt to define the job to be done.	Team members resist the task demands.	There is an open exchange of views about the team's problems.	Resources are allocated efficiently; processes are in place to ensure that the final objective is achieved.	Handoff of tasks or responsibilities takes place with resistance.
PROCESS ISSUES	Team members look outside for guidance and direction.	Team members deny the task and look for reasons not to do it.	The team starts to set up the procedures to deal with the task.	The team is able to solve problems.	Team conducts follow up assessment of work and each other.
FEELINGS ISSUES	People feel anxious and are unsure of their roles. Most look to a leader or a coordinator for guidance.	People still feel uncertain and try to express their individuality. Concerns arise about the team hierarchy.	People ignore individual differences and team members are more accepting of one another.	People share a common focus, communicate effectively and become more efficient and flexible as a result.	Mourning like period as project or time together closes.

Characteristics of individual stages of team development

Five Stages of Team Development

- As a leader within your organization, your goal is to help your staff perform well and as quickly as possible. To do this, you'll need to flex your style at each stage.
- Follow the steps below to ensure that you're doing the right thing at the right time:
 1. Identify the stage of team development that your team is at from the descriptions above.
 2. Consider what you need to do to move towards the performing stage.
 3. Schedule regular reviews of where your team is, and adjust your behavior and leadership style appropriately to accommodate your team's current status.

Five Stages of Team Development

- Leader's activities

	ACTIVITIES
FORMING	1. Direct the team, and establish clear objectives, both for the team as a whole and for individual team members.
STORMING	1. Establish processes and structures. 2. Build trust and good relationships between team members. 3. Resolve conflicts swiftly if they occur. Provide support, especially to those team members who are less secure. 4. Remain positive and firm in the face of challenges to your leadership, or to the team's goal. 5. Explain the "forming, storming, norming, and performing" idea, so that people understand why problems are occurring, and so that they see that things will get better in the future. Coach team members in assertiveness and conflict resolution skills, where this is necessary.
NORMING	1. Step back and help team members to take responsibility for progress towards the goal. (This is a good time to arrange a team-building event.)
PERFORMING	1. Delegate tasks and projects as far as you can. Once the team is achieving well, you should aim to have as light a touch as possible. You will now be able to start focusing on other goals and areas of work.
ADJOURNING	1. Take the time to celebrate the team's achievements – you may work with some of your people again, and this will be much easier if people view past experiences positively.



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5 Dysfunctions of a Team

Based on:

<https://www.codot.gov/business/process-improvement/self-service/books/the-five-dysfunctions-of-a-team>

<https://medium.com/taskworld-blog/lencionis-5-dysfunctions-of-a-team-330d58b2cd81>

<http://jrwoodward.net/2008/05/the-five-dysfunctions-of-a-team/>

<https://peopleleaders.com.au/lencionis-5-dysfunctions-of-a-team/>

Lencioni's 5 Dysfunctions of a Team



Patrick Lencioni in his book “The Five Dysfunctions of a Team” identifies five dysfunctions that plague the success and connectivity of teams.

Lencioni's 5 Dysfunctions of a Team

1. Absence of Trust

- The first dysfunction is an *absence of trust* among team members.
- Essentially, this stems from their unwillingness to be vulnerable within the group.
- Team members who are not genuinely open with one another about their mistakes and weaknesses make it impossible to build a foundation of trust.

2. Fear of Conflict

- This failure to build trust is damaging because it sets the tone for the second dysfunction: *fear of conflict*.
- Teams that lack trust are incapable of engaging in unfiltered and passionate debate of ideas.
- Instead, they resort to veiled discussions and guarded comments.

Lencioni's 5 Dysfunctions of a Team

3. Lack of Commitment

- A lack of healthy conflict is a problem because it ensures the third dysfunction of a team: *lack of commitment*.
- Without having aired their opinions in the course of passionate and open debate, team members rarely, if ever, buy in and commit to decisions, though they may feign agreement during meetings.

4. Avoidance of Accountability

- Because of this lack of real commitment and buy-in, team members develop an *avoidance of accountability*, the fourth dysfunction.
- Without committing to a clear plan of action, even the most focused and driven people often hesitate to call their peers on actions and behaviors that seem counterproductive to the good of the team.

Lencioni's 5 Dysfunctions of a Team

5. Inattention to Results

- Failure to hold one another accountable creates an environment where the fifth dysfunction can thrive.
- *Inattention to results* occurs when team members put their individual needs (such as ego, career development, or recognition) or even the needs of their divisions above the collective goals of the team.

Lencioni's 5 Dysfunctions of a Team

	DESCRIPTION
Inattention to Results	▪ The pursuit of individual goals and personal status erodes the focus on collective success.
Avoidance of Accountability	▪ The need to avoid interpersonal discomfort prevents team members from holding one another accountable.
Lack of Commitment	▪ The lack of clarity or buy-in prevents team members from making decisions they will stick to.
Fear of Conflict	▪ The desire to preserve artificial harmony stifles the occurrence of productive ideological conflict.
Absence of Trust	▪ The fear of being vulnerable with team members prevents the building of trust within the team.

Overcoming the 5 Dysfunctions of a Team

Dysfunction #1 : Absence of Trust

- **PROBLEM:** This occurs when team members are reluctant to be vulnerable with one another and are unwilling to admit their mistakes, weaknesses, or need for help.
- Without a certain comfort level among team members, a foundation of trust is not possible.
- **SOLUTION:** As the manager, set the good example by asking for help from your team members, admitting your own weaknesses and limitations, and be the first to own up to a mistake.
- When you take the lead, others will follow.
- Slowly, these habits will become culture and the team will begin to build the first unshakable brick in the pyramid — trust.

Overcoming the 5 Dysfunctions of a Team

Dysfunction #2: Fear of Conflict

- **PROBLEM:** Teams that lack trust are incapable of engaging in unfiltered, passionate debate about key issues, causing situations where team conflict can easily turn into veiled discussions and back channel comments.
- In a work setting where team members do not openly air their opinions, there is a lot of posturing and precious time is wasted, resulting in inferior decisions.
- **SOLUTION:** Establish that conflict is welcome and purposeful.
- Define what healthy conflict looks like by praising healthy examples or giving corrective feedback if conflict veers towards unhealthy.
- You can also “mine for conflict” by opening a meeting with a bad idea to see if everyone will agree to avoid conflict, and use this as a litmus test to open up healthy discussion.
- Lastly, you can designate a devil’s advocate in a meeting, or use pro and con lists for ideas to get people to open up to sharing a differing perspective.

Overcoming the 5 Dysfunctions of a Team

Dysfunction #3: Lack of Commitment

- **PROBLEM:** Without conflict, it is difficult for team members to commit to decisions, creating an environment where ambiguity prevails.
- Lack of direction and commitment can make employees, particularly star employees, dissatisfied.
- **SOLUTION:** Clarity and closure are paramount to overcome this dysfunction and move to the next level.
- Setting clear deadlines, reviewing key decisions at the end of meetings as well as what should and should not be communicated to other staff and contingency planning can help teams overcome their fears by creating clear plans and facing potential pitfalls and the fear of failure head on so everyone can commit.

Overcoming the 5 Dysfunctions of a Team

Dysfunction #4: Avoidance of Team Accountability

- **PROBLEM:** When teams do not commit to a clear plan of action, even the most focused and driven individuals hesitate to call their peers on actions and behaviors that may seem counterproductive to the overall good of the team.
- This allows for mediocrity, poor performers to slip by and the leader to become the soul source of discipline.
- **SOLUTION:** If teams have come this far, they have trust and commitment, then they will know that a team member calling them out not only has the right to do so because expectations and deadlines were clear, but that it is not a personal attack.
- This allows team members to confront difficult issues to hold each other accountable.
- Clear standards, progress reviews and team rewards are also important to make sure this area stays healthy.

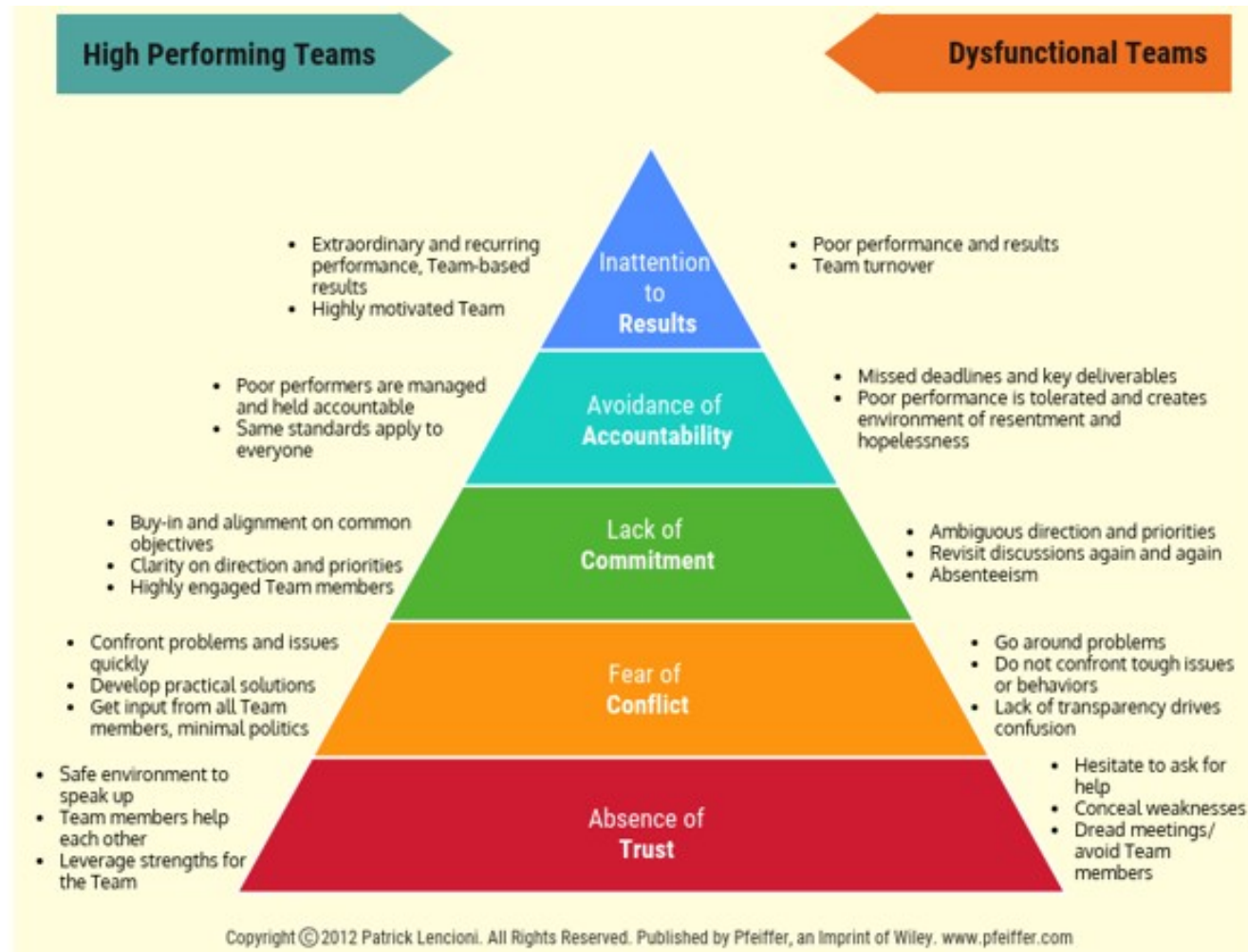
Overcoming the 5 Dysfunctions of a Team

Dysfunction #5: Inattention to Team Objectives

- **PROBLEM:** Team members naturally tend to put their own needs (ego, career development, recognition, etc.) ahead of the collective goals of the team when individuals aren't held accountable.
- If a team has lost sight of the need for achievement, the business ultimately suffers.
- **SOLUTION:** When teams have a solid base of trust, healthy conflict, commitment and team accountability and are recognized within the company for performance via praise or rewards, it will be easier for team members to put their own needs aside for the sake of the team.
- With these solutions, teams should be able to retain top performers, handle failure with resilience and stay focused.

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Overcoming the 5 Dysfunctions of a Team



Overcoming the 5 Dysfunctions of a Team

Dysfunction	Effective Team Characteristics
Lack of trust —People don't feel safe to reveal mistakes, share concerns, or express ideas.	Trust —Members trust one another on a deep emotional level; feel comfortable being vulnerable with one another.
Fear of conflict —People go along with others for the sake of harmony; don't express conflicting opinions.	Healthy conflict —Members feel comfortable disagreeing and challenging one another in the interest of finding the best solution.
Lack of commitment —If people are afraid to express their true opinions, it's difficult to gain their true commitment to decisions.	Commitment —Because all ideas are put on the table, people can achieve genuine buy-in around important goals and decisions eventually.
Avoidance of accountability —People don't accept responsibility for outcomes; engage in finger-pointing when things go wrong.	Accountability —Members hold one another accountable rather than relying on managers as the source of accountability.
Inattention to results —Members put personal ambition or the needs of their individual departments ahead of collective results.	Results orientation —Individual members set aside personal agendas; focus on what's best for the team. Collective results define success.



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Thank You very much
for your attention